

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

We have some interesting and beautiful paper art laid out for you to check out. Additionally, check out our reviews for Black Mirror Season 5, Men in Black International and more.



Dark Forest Internet

Because of the general toxicity of online interactions, and the pervasive spread of misinformation, people around the world are retreating to private channels. These include groups on discord or slack, private versions of Instagram, or invite only groups on instant messaging apps.

<https://dgit.in/dfnet>

WHAT'S NEW

Gutenberg did not invent the printing press

The Gutenberg press is considered to be the invention that sparked the printing revolution, allowing knowledge to be transferred cheaply in the form of books. However, the printing press was actually invented in China in 800 AD. Books were printed using wooden blocks. When these technologies were imported to Korea, a Buddhist having to print out a voluminous treatise, concluded that the effort would be futile using only wooden blocks, as it would require carving a large number of blocks. Civil minister, Choe Yun-ui came up with the solution of using bronze coins to caste metal



alphabets. These alphabets were arranged in a wooden frame to print a particular page. The letters could then be rearranged to create other pages. Choe finished the project in 1250. Gutenberg began working on his press around 1436. The technological development possibly spread from the East to the West.

<https://dgit.in/noguten>

What if Thanos erased half the life on Earth?

What would happen to the ecosystem of Earth if the snap really took place? The effects would vary from species-to-species depending on the rate at which they reproduced. Species that reproduce rapidly, like frogs and rats would return to their pre-snap population levels within a year. Mosquitoes would replenish their population within four months. The effect would be drastic on animals that breed slowly. The



snap would decimate the tiger population, pushing them on the path of extinction. Other critically-endangered species, would also be pushed towards extinction, because they wouldn't be able to find mates.

The species in the lower rungs of the food chain would be less affected than the species at the top. Species that go extinct would leave open ecological niches, to be taken over by the rapidly-breeding species. Common creatures would get more common and the rare would get rarer. The good news? The eradication of half of the human population would save some endangered species.

<https://dgit.in/snapanim>



Anaconda virgin birth

An anaconda named Anna in the New England Aquarium surprised the staff when she delivered a litter of baby snakes on her own, without a father. The birth took place through a process known as parthenogenesis. DNA testing of the babies confirmed the single parenthood.

<https://dgit.in/anna>



Heartbreak is painful

Researchers studying human reactions and emotions in a VR environment noticed that the same regions of the brain gets active when faced with rejection, as a physical injury. As far as the brain is concerned, there is no difference between a fracture and a broken heart.

<https://dgit.in/heartbreak>



Mystery moon mass

Researchers have discovered a massive anomaly near the south pole of the Moon. There is about 2.18 quintillion kgs of metallic material, an abnormal amount to have accumulated in one place. The mass may be the remains of an ancient asteroid impact, with a metallic core.

<https://dgit.in/mm>